

BRANDON MINER

San Francisco, CA

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Public Technologist — Data systems for civil liberties, government accountability, and privacy advocacy

Education

University of San Francisco

M.S. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence

San Francisco, CA

Expected Jun 2026

San Diego State University

B.S. in Statistics with Emphasis in Data Science, Minor in Mathematics

San Diego, CA

Dec 2025

Experience

Data Scientist

ACLU

San Francisco, CA

Oct 2025 – Present

- Followed agile development methodologies to create an end-to-end ML video auditing platform (**Python, FastAPI, MySQL, Docker**) to automate settlement requirements review of police bodycam footage, projected to eliminate **300+ hours** of manual review per monthly cycle and expand oversight capacity to amplify the criminal justice system.
- Developing a GPU-accelerated ETL pipeline using **FFmpeg** and **Whisper**-based speech-to-text to ingest, transcribe, and process **600+ police videos per month**, with **LLM-driven auto-labeling** to flag potential rights violations and misconduct patterns for legal review.
- Delivering the full auditing system to non-technical legal and advocacy staff via a **private-server FastAPI backend** and **React.js** web frontend, ensuring sensitive footage remains secure and off commercial infrastructure.
- Leading a **geospatial privacy analysis** initiative to expose deanonymization risks in commercially sold location data, directly informing advocacy efforts for legislative bans on data broker practices.
- Engineered a spatial data pipeline using **Plotly**, OpenStreetMap, and the **Google Reverse Geocoding API** to translate raw GPS coordinates into identifiable behavioral patterns, applying **DBSCAN clustering** to detect sensitive personal locations (home, work, medical facilities) from purportedly anonymized data, producing concrete evidentiary exhibits for policy arguments.

Data Scientist, Lead Intern

San Diego County Taxpayers Association

San Diego, CA

Mar 2024 – Aug 2025

- Learned team leadership through statistical analysis initiatives I led across collaborative civic policy research, managing a team of **4+ associates** to deliver quantitative analysis on public workforce, government spending, and homelessness programs for public reporting.
- Built a public workforce analytics pipeline using iterative **web scraping** and **NLP-based standardization** to analyze wage dynamics, identifying significant taxpayer cost of **19.7%** police wage increase per **1%** staffing drop).
- Analyzed regional homelessness expenditure using **mixed-effects models** and **multicollinearity reduction** to evaluate program efficacy, identifying high-impact interventions like rapid rehousing to guide future public resource allocation.

Technical Projects

California Grape ETL Pipeline & Dashboard

- Engineered a multi-source ETL pipeline** in Python to extract, transform, and consolidate disparate agricultural datasets into a unified schema, making government-held data accessible for public analysis.
- Containerized and deployed a technical delivery** via Docker Compose and **Google Cloud Run**, ensuring reliable public access to a **live interactive Streamlit dashboard** for data visualization of regional production data.

Credit Card Fraud Detection

- Built a binary classification model using **Logistic Regression (Scikit-Learn)** to identify fraudulent transactions on a highly imbalanced dataset.

Technical Skills

Programming & Tools: Python (Pandas, PyTorch, FastAPI, Streamlit, Plotly), SQL (PostgreSQL), R, Bash

Civic & Public-Interest Tech: government data pipelines, web scraping, geospatial analysis (DBSCAN, OpenStreetMap), privacy/deanonymization analysis, public dashboards

ML & NLP: multi-stage text classification, LLM-assisted labeling, mixed-effects regression, statistical reporting

Deployment & Security: private-server deployment, Docker, secure off-commercial-cloud delivery, stakeholder communication with legal/advocacy teams